



Leaf blade ➤ Many grasses have long, thin leaves with parallel veins running down the length of each blade. Each new leaf emerges from within the base of the older blade.

Sweet vernal grass

Roots ➤ Grasses have very dense root systems that hold the plant in place even when being tugged at by large grazing animals. These root clusters also hold the soil together, preventing erosion.

Leaf sheaths grow at the base of each grass leaf. Wrapped around the stem, leaf sheaths prevent stems from breaking and also protect the growing point.

Grass imposters

Rush

This snowy woodrush has long, thin leaves that may look like those of a grass, but it is actually a rush and belongs to a related family of plants.



Seagrass

These seagrasses live on the ocean floor, providing an important habitat and food source for a wide range of fish and other marine life.

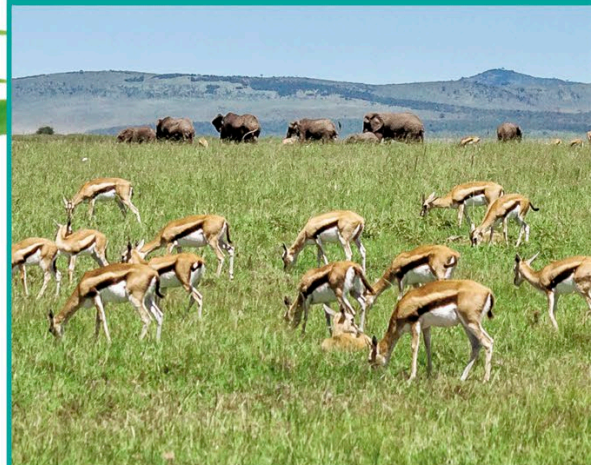


Sedge

Sedges are wetland plants with grasslike leaves, but you can tell them apart from grasses and rushes by their triangular stems.



Grasslands



Grassland habitats cover about a third of all land on Earth. They are found in regions too dry to support a forest but too wet to be a desert. From African savannas to North American prairies to European meadows, grasslands support a huge variety of wildlife around the world, such as the Grant's gazelles seen here. Wildfires often sweep across grasslands, encouraging thick grass regrowth and removing tree seedlings.